

A BIKINI TALE

Who Former Miss Afghanistan, Vida Samadzai, 32, slammed by the Afghan Supreme Court for her bikini act at a beauty pageant in 2003.

What The Bollywood aspirant had her journey cut short after India labelled her an "inadmissible passenger" and sent her back.

Where Condemned by Afghanistan and banned from India, the US national is now cooling her heels in Europe.



GFTTY IMAGES



PHOTOGRAPH

DIRECT HIT

Nandita Das has been out of action for a while but her year has started off with a bang. Even though *Firaaq* didn't make too many waves in India, her directorial debut continues to score abroad. The film scooped up three awards at the Imagine India Film Festival in Madrid. It was also adjudged the Best Film in the Indian, Asian and International section while the 40-year-old was named Best Director. The celebrations have begun even before her first baby arrives. Her new husband sure seems to be a lucky charm.

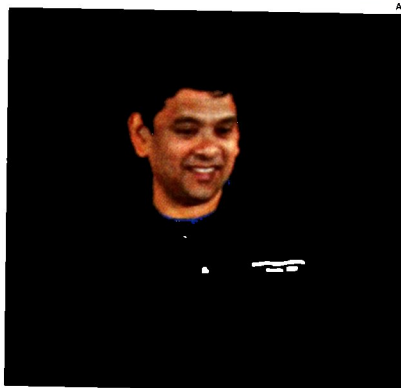
The Third Half

It seems, Adnan Sami doesn't tire of marriage, even after a public thrashing from wife number two, Sabah Galadari. Now, he's tied the knot with Afghani German, Roya Faryabi, who is not put off by his history. And this one seems doomed from the start too. Instead of fancy restaurants and lavish holidays, Sami has been dragging her to the graves of his idols, Beethoven and Mozart. He just doesn't seem to learn.

SAMI WITH WIFE FARYABI



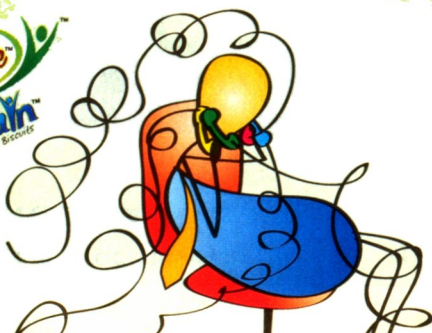
YOGEN SHAH



AP

Star Trekker

Indian American Shyam Bhaskaran is leaping into space history. The 46-year-old was on a team that recently steered the landing of the world's first asteroid explorer, Japan's Hayabusa. The Mumbai man played a key role in navigating the spacecraft. Bhaskaran is part of NASA's Outer Planets Navigation Group and is now based in California. He is aiming for the stars.



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